

I promise there are no references to smashed avocado in this book. The debate around eating more or less squished stone fruit has pulped an important and emotional matter – the basic right to afford a roof over your head – down to a trivial punchline. What you will delay and sacrifice is a lot more than brunch; it is likely to be not having a wedding, children or an enriching holiday, or not moving out of your parents' nest to enjoy independence, just yet. It's going to be tough, but it's doable.

If you are reading this, then you must be serious – and hopeful – about buying a home. I wish you the best of luck – and happy housewarming, in anticipation.